

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

It was the strangest island!



Learning Outcome

Relate information about common solutions to problems in spoken or written documents.

Ask your partner:

- How would you describe an island?
- What do you think about the use of natural resources such as an island to develop military operations?

Can Do Statements

- I can discuss coincidences, strange events or superstitions.
- I can talk about things that happened or have happened.
- I can talk about my attitudes toward an action.





Let's Explore!

Okunoshima has a **dark past***.

* When a place has a "dark past", something bad happened there.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Okunoshima island, I was shocked to find out, has had a dark past. You can arrange to visit this small Japanese island that's only a short trip from the mainland. A place, that for many years, did not in fact exist.

Between 1929 and 1945 the island was home to the Japanese army and was used to house a secret poison gas factory. Because of this, the island was removed from Japanese maps. It just appeared to disappear!

The army chose to use Okunoshima because it had a discreet location and is far from civilian populations. They decided to bring rabbits onto the island so that they could test the effects of the poison gas on them.

Today the island has changed. The poison gas factory has closed down and has been replaced by a museum. The military lookout posts that were on the island have fallen into disrepair. However, the descendants of the the unfortunate test rabbits are still there, and they have grown in number.

These days, the island has a hotel, a small camping ground and a golf course. Visitors to the island can enjoy swimming in the clean water that surrounds the island. But all that most day-visitors think about doing is feeding the feral rabbits. After all, they are the real attraction.

Imagine roaming wooded areas and walking the paths, being chased by hundreds of wild bunnies! You can't help thinking how cute they are, even when they are swarming all over you trying to get to that food you brought along!





Let's Practice!

The island was used by the military!

Instructions: Classify the following sentences into the given categories

- 1) The military lookout posts around the island have fallen into ruin.
- 2) It was used to house a secret poison gas factory.
- 3) The poison gas factory has closed down.
- 4) Between 1929 - 1945 the island was home to the Japanese army.
- 5) The unfortunate test rabbits have grown in number.
- 6) The army chose the island for its location.

Simple Past

Present Perfect



Let's Practice!

You can visit the island!

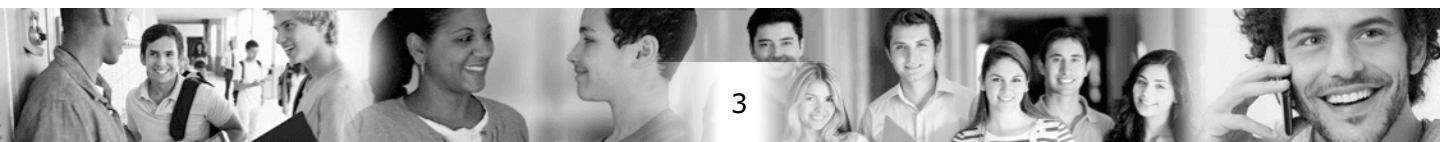
Instructions: Unscramble the words to find the mystery sentence.

- 1) / visit the / off the mainland. / small Japanese island/ you can arrange to/

- 2) /civilian populations./ The army chose/ because of /Okunoshima / its distance from/

- 3) / clean water / the island . /Visitors / in the sounding / can enjoy swimming /

- 4) / they are. / You / can't help / how cute / thinking /





Extension Activity

Find out about an island that's interesting.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online or to the library to find out about an interesting island.
- Find out where it is, what happens there, who goes there and what there is to do.
- Explain why it is interesting.
- Write 200 words giving the full information in your own words.
- Try to use verb + gerund and verb + infinitive in your writing.
- Read your writing to a partner.
- Discuss your island with them and get their opinion of it as well.

Self-Assessment

Yes **No**

I find out about an interesting island.

☐ ☐

I write the full information about it in 200 words.

☐ ☐

I use verb + gerund and verb + infinitive in my writing about the island.

☐ ☐

I share my written piece with a partner.

☐ ☐

I ask my partner for his or her opinion of the island.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to shock** (verb): to cause (someone) to feel surprised and upset
e.g. Okunoshima island, I was shocked to find out, has had a dark past.
- feral** (adjective): not domesticated
e.g. Most visitors think about feeding the feral rabbits.
- poison** (noun): something that can cause serious harm to the body if consumed
e.g. The island was used to house a secret poison gas factory.
- gas** (noun): an airlike fluid substance with the ability to expand without limit
e.g. The poison gas factory has closed down.
- to remove** (verb): to eliminate
e.g. The island was removed from Japanese maps.
- discreet** (adjective): careful or tactful in one's conduct or speech
e.g. The army chose to use Okunoshima because it has a discreet location.
- to appear** (verb): to seem
e.g. The island just appeared to disappear!
- civilian** (noun): a person who is not with the military
e.g. The poison gas plant is far from civilian populations.
- military** (noun): the armed forces
e.g. The military lookout posts that were on the island have fallen into disrepair.
- lookout post** (noun): a place for a guard or a soldier to keep watch
e.g. The soldier left his lookout post after his shift.





Learning Points

Present Perfect Tense vs. Simple Past Tense

You use the **Present Perfect**:

- For something that started in the past and continues in the present.

Example:

I have studied English since 2014.

- For something that has been done several times.

Example:

I have read this book four times.

- For experiences up to the present.

Example:

This is the best trip I've ever had.

- For something that happened in the past but is relevant at the time of speaking.

Example:

I can't call her. I've lost my cellphone.

- For referring to a time that is not yet finished.

Example:

Have you seen Richard today?

You use the **Simple Past** for:

- Something that was finished at a certain period of time.

Example:

I saw Richard yesterday.

I finished my project two hours ago.

Sentence	When
<i>Between 1929-1945 the island was home to the Japanese army.</i>	between 1929 and 1945
<i>It just appeared to disappear!</i>	at the time previously mentioned
<i>The poison gas factory has closed down and has been replaced by a museum.</i>	sometime after the war ended but when is not stated
<i>The unfortunate test rabbits are still there and they have grown in number.</i>	since they were set free sometime in the past





Learning Points

Examples:

- *It was used to house a secret poison gas factory.*
- *Because of this, the island was removed from Japanese maps.*
- *Today the island has changed.*
- *The military lookout posts that were on the island have fallen into disrepair.*

Gerunds and Infinitives

A **gerund** is a verb ending with -ing (doing).

An **infinitive** is to + verb (to do).

There are some verbs that can only be followed by a gerund:

think about (doing)

imagine (doing)

can't help (doing)

Example:

Imagine walking roaming wooded areas and walking the paths, **being** chased by hundreds of wild bunnies!

You always use a gerund after a phrasal verb.

Example:

*But all that most day-visitors **think about** doing is feeding the feral rabbits.*

There are some verbs that can only be followed by an infinitive:

shocked (to do)

used (to do)

arrange (to do)

appear (to do)

choose (to do)

decide (to do)

be able (to do)

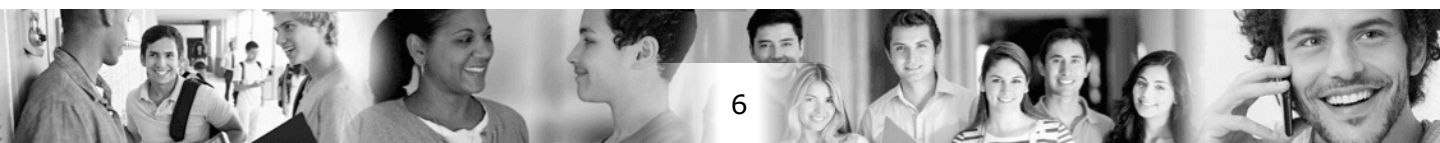
Example:

*It was **used to** house a secret poison gas factory.*

There are some verbs that can be followed by either an infinitive or a gerund with a difference in meaning:

try (to do): attempt unsuccessfully

try (doing): experiment by doing different things





Learning Points

Examples:

They are trying to get to that food you brought along!
(they haven't been successful)

You should **try leaving** the bag of food and **moving** away from it to lose them.
(experiment that way first)

Examples:

- Okunoshima island, I was **shocked to** find out, has had a dark past.
- You can **arrange to** visit this small Japanese island that's only a short trip from the mainland.
- The army **chose to** use Okunoshima because it has a discreet location and is far from civilian populations.
- They **decided to** bring rabbits onto the island so that they could test the effects of the poison on them.
- Visitors to the island can **enjoy swimming** in the clean water that surrounds the island.
- It just **appeared to** disappear!
- You **can't help thinking** how cute they are, even when they are swarming all over you.

